IELTS Turbo · Week 10 · Wednesday · Listening and Reading

Architecture, art and design

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Art, buildings and the beauty of design (170 words)

Great buildings are works of art as well as shelters. A skilled **architect** chooses the **facade** and the shape of a **dome** or **column** with care, and a famous **landmark** can become a symbol of a whole city. A **Gothic** cathedral, with its tall windows, shows how medieval builders pushed the limits of stone. Many old buildings are **in need of repair**, so experts **restore** or **renovate** them to protect the national **monument** heritage.

Art follows similar traditions. A painter may work on a large **canvas** to produce a **portrait**, while a sculptor shapes metal or stone into a **sculpture**. A museum **curator** selects pieces for an **exhibition** in a public **gallery**, and visitors often admire a true **masterpiece** for hours. Some artists prefer an **abstract** style that avoids realistic shapes, others a patient **craft** such as **pottery**.

Good design is more than decoration: an **aesthetic** judgment guides every choice. As new styles **catch on**, designers must find ways of **blending in** with the past while giving each project a fresh identity.

Useful phrases from the article

Phrase	Meaning
in need of repair	damaged
catch on	become popular
blending in	fitting well

The 20 new words

Word		Meaning	Example
architect	n	a person who designs buildings	*The architect won an award.*
facade	n	the front of a building	*The facade was covered in glass.*
landmark	n	a famous building or place	*The tower is a city landmark.*
sculpture	n	a work of art in stone or metal	*The sculpture stands in the square.*
portrait	n	a picture of a person	*The portrait shows the queen.*
exhibition	n	a public show of art	*The exhibition opened in May.*
masterpiece	n	an outstanding work of art	*The painting is a masterpiece.*
abstract	adj	not showing real objects	*Abstract art uses shapes and colors.*

renovate	v	to repair and improve a building	*They renovated the old theater.*
restore	v	to bring back to its original state	*Experts restored the fresco.*
Gothic	adj	a style of medieval architecture	*The Gothic cathedral has tall windows.*
column	n	a tall vertical post supporting a building	*Marble columns line the hall.*
dome	n	a round roof	*The dome is visible from far away.*
canvas	n	cloth for painting	*He painted on a large canvas.*
curator	n	a person who looks after a museum collection	*The curator chose forty paintings.*
gallery	n	a place where art is shown	*The gallery is open daily.*
craft	n	skill in making things by hand	*Traditional crafts are disappearing.*
pottery	n	objects made from baked clay	*Ancient pottery was found at the site.*
aesthetic	adj	connected with beauty	*The design has great aesthetic value.*
monument	n	a structure built to remember something	*The monument honors the soldiers.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

Word		Meaning
entrepreneur	n	a person who starts new businesses
startup	n	a new small business
revenue	n	the money a company receives
market share	n	the part of sales a company controls
customer loyalty	n	customers who keep buying from you
competitor	n	a rival company
merger	n	the joining of two companies
supply chain	n	the steps from making to selling goods
demand	n	the wish of buyers to purchase
supply	n	the amount of goods available

Practice: fill the gaps

canvas · Gothic · curator · sculpture · craft · masterpiece · abstract · architect

1. He painted on a large _____.
2. The _____ cathedral has tall windows.

3. The _____ chose forty paintings.
4. The _____ stands in the square.
5. Traditional _____ are disappearing.
6. The painting is a _____.
7. _____ art uses shapes and colors.
8. The _____ won an award.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

ancient monument (n): an old structure of national importance
arch (n): a curved structure over an opening
avant-garde (adj): very new and experimental
baroque (adj): a rich, decorative style
brushstroke (n): a mark made by a brush
bust (n): a sculpture of a head and shoulders
ceiling (n): the top of a room
chapel (n): a small church
collage (n): a picture made of pasted pieces
contemporary (adj): of the present time
cubism (n): a style using geometric shapes
decorative (adj): used to make things look nice
drawing (n): a picture made with a pencil
engraving (n): a picture cut into metal
fresco (n): a painting on a wall
heritage (n): the culture inherited from the past
impressionism (n): a style that captures light
installation (n): an art work set in a space
landscape (n): a painting of countryside
mosaic (n): a picture made from small pieces
mural (n): a large wall painting
oil painting (n): a painting made with oil paint
palace (n): a large, grand home of a ruler
sketch (n): a quick drawing
spire (n): a tall pointed tower
stained glass (n): colored glass in a window
still life (n): a painting of objects
studio (n): an artist's workroom
tapestry (n): a woven picture
watercolor (n): a painting made with water paint

Answers

1. canvas (canvas)
2. Gothic (Gothic)
3. curator (curator)
4. sculpture (sculpture)
5. crafts (craft)
6. masterpiece (masterpiece)
7. Abstract (abstract)
8. architect (architect)